MCCJ 525 / CYBERCRIMES AND SECURITY

Think Like a Hacker

Five platforms through the offender's eyes, **and the guardians that stop them**

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Group [__] | [Department], [University] | [Date]

Crime happens when three things meet in the same place



ROUTINE ACTIVITY THEORY / COHEN & FELSON (1979)

We can’t remove the offenders, and we can’t stop being targets. The one corner we control is the guardian.

21.65% of victims had an account hacked, the #1 cybercrime

78.78% of victims are aged 18–30

12% reported it to the police

Sources: Cohen & Felson (1979); Cyber Crime Awareness Foundation (2024), reported by Dhaka Tribune; Statista (2025).

A hacker sizes up every account with five questions

THE HACKER ASKS		THE GUARDIAN WE SCORED (1–5 EACH, MAX 25)
01	*"Can I get in with just a stolen password?"*	**Login protection**
02	*"Can messages be read on the company's servers?"*	**Encryption by default**
03	*"Will the owner be warned that I'm in?"*	**Threat alerts**
04	*"Can I lock the real owner out?"*	**Recovery safety**
05	*"Can I find and message the victim?"*	**Privacy controls**

Evidence: every security setting on our own accounts, cross-checked with official help pages and news (October 2026). Targets ranked from softest to hardest.

Telegram: the softest target of the five

THE HACKER'S PLAN

"Most chats aren't end-to-end encrypted, and few users ever set a cloud password. I join their groups and wait."

WEAK SPOT

Encryption is opt-in: ordinary chats, groups and channels sit on Telegram's servers. Since Sept 2024, IPs and numbers can be shared on valid legal request.

GUARDIANS IN THE WAY

- Two-step cloud password
- Passcode lock and active-session control
- Hide phone number; connect by username
- Secret Chats: end-to-end encrypted

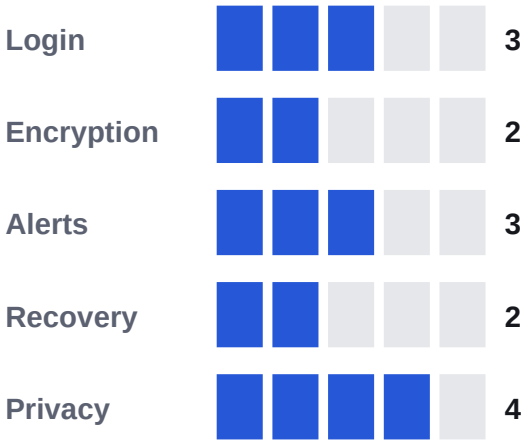
GUARDIAN TO ADD

Encrypt one-to-one chats by default, and prompt two-step verification at sign-up.

GUARDIAN STRENGTH

14/25

SOFTEST TARGET



Source: Engadget (2024).

Facebook: strong locks, but the back door is recovery

THE HACKER'S PLAN

"I phish the password with a fake "copyright violation" notice, then swap the recovery email and phone before the owner wakes up."

WEAK SPOT

Recovery details can be changed in minutes, while getting the account back is slow and largely automated.

GUARDIANS IN THE WAY

- Two-factor authentication: app, SMS or key
- Login alerts and remote log-out
- Passkeys on mobile since June 2025
- Profile lock; Messenger encrypted by default

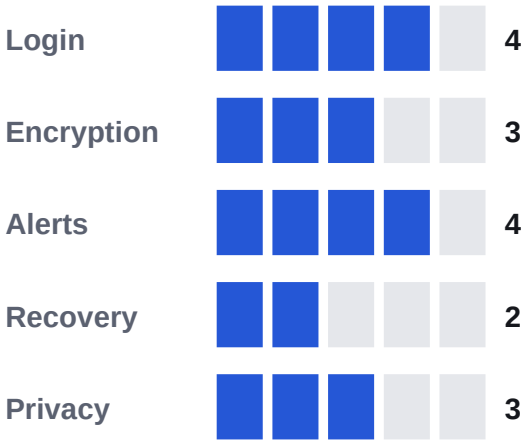
GUARDIAN TO ADD

A 48-hour cool-down on recovery changes, alerts to old contacts, and Bangla-language human support.

GUARDIAN STRENGTH

16/25

TARGET 2



Sources: Meta (2025); Crisan (2023).

Instagram: once inside, the DMs are an open book

THE HACKER'S PLAN

"I get in through linked Meta accounts and read the DMs. They aren't end-to-end encrypted, so private photos become my leverage."

WEAK SPOT

DMs were never encrypted by default, and Meta removed the optional encrypted chats on 8 May 2026.

GUARDIANS IN THE WAY

- Same Meta 2FA, login alerts and login activity
- "Emails from Instagram" exposes fake emails
- Restrict and Hidden Words
- Teen Accounts private by default

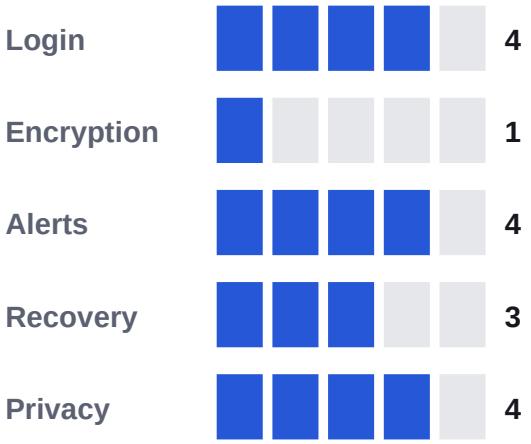
GUARDIAN TO ADD

Restore end-to-end encrypted DMs as the default, and blur unsolicited explicit images for all users.

GUARDIAN STRENGTH

16/25

TARGET 3



Source: Euronews (2026).

Gmail: the prize every hacker wants, and the hardest to steal

THE HACKER'S PLAN

"Gmail is the master key: every reset link lands here. But with a passkey, there is no password for me to phish."

WEAK SPOT

Personal mail is not end-to-end encrypted, and users who reuse passwords without 2-Step Verification hand over the master key.

GUARDIANS IN THE WAY

- Passkeys as the default sign-in since Oct 2023
- 2-Step Verification and Security Checkup
- Critical alerts for suspicious sign-ins
- Blocks 99.9%+ of phishing and malware (Google)

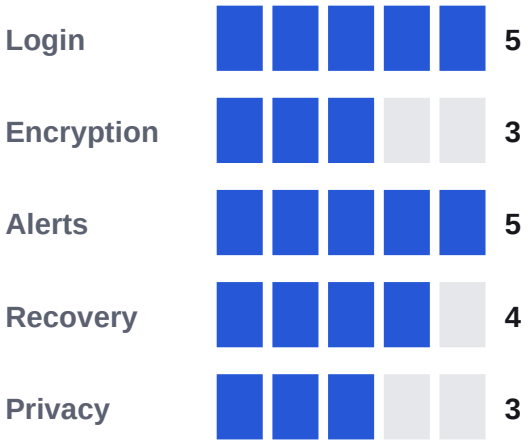
GUARDIAN TO ADD

Optional end-to-end encryption for personal mail, and lookalike warnings for bKash, Nagad and local banks.

GUARDIAN STRENGTH

20/25

TARGET 4



Sources: Google (2023); Engadget (2025).

WhatsApp: the hardest target, so hackers attack the person

THE HACKER'S PLAN

"I can't break the encryption, so I break the person: 'I sent my code to you by mistake, please forward it.'"

WEAK SPOT

The phone number is the identity. Without a two-step PIN, one shared six-digit code hands over the account.

GUARDIANS IN THE WAY

- End-to-end encryption on every chat and call
- Six-digit two-step verification PIN
- Passkeys and passkey-locked backups
- Strict Account Settings (Jan 2026)

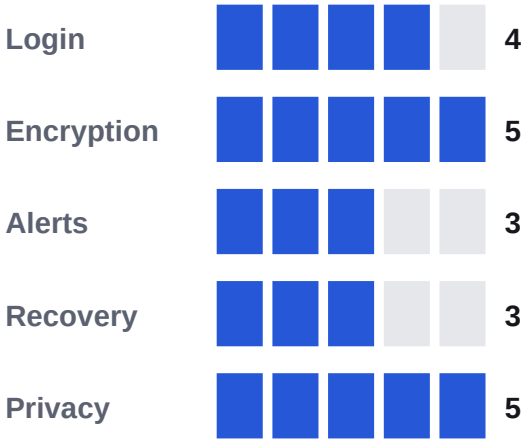
GUARDIAN TO ADD

A Bangla warning whenever a registration code is requested, and a mandatory two-step PIN.

GUARDIAN STRENGTH

20/25

HARDEST TARGET

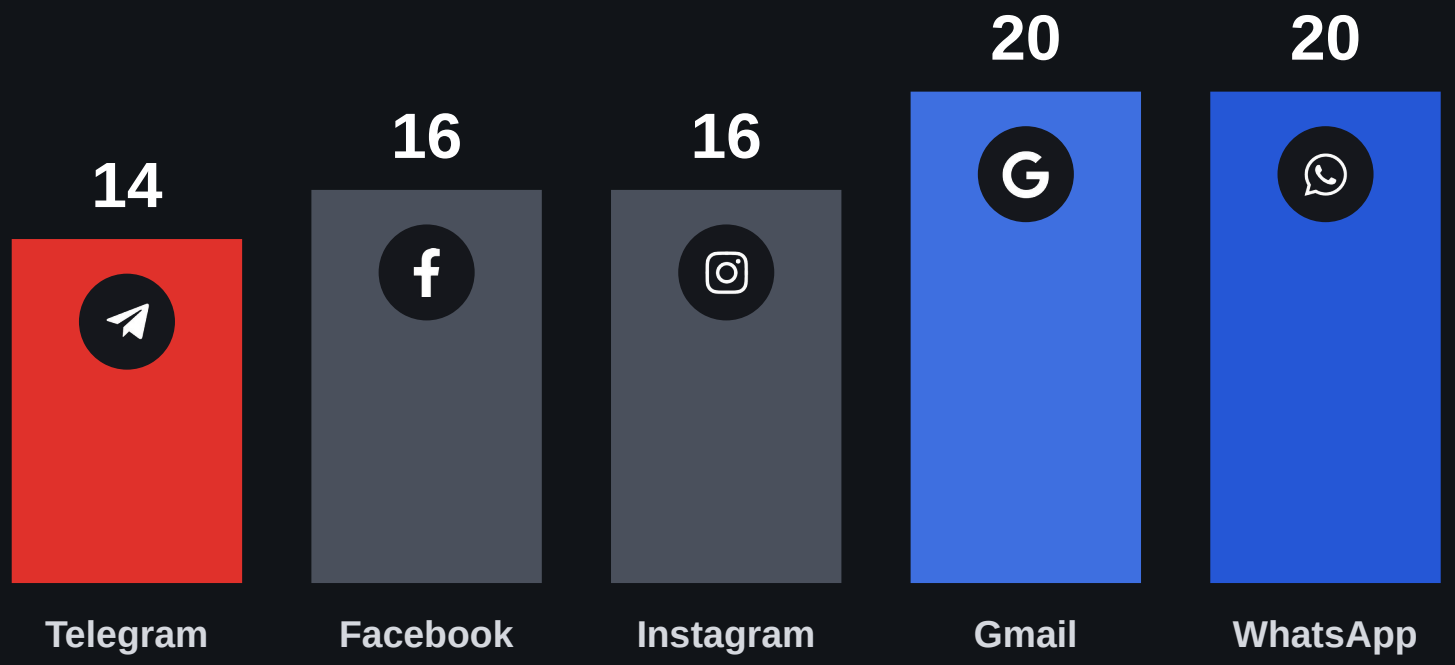


Sources: WhatsApp (2026); Help Net Security (2025).

WhatsApp is the hardest target, and the most secure for you

SOFTEST

HARDEST



Guardian strength out of 25; the group's assessment of default and available settings, October 2026.

HARDEST TO HACK: WHATSAPP

Its strongest guardian, end-to-end encryption, is on from day one with no setup.

THE PRIZE TO GUARD: GMAIL

The master key to every other account; protect it with a passkey.

SOFTEST TARGET: TELEGRAM

A privacy reputation stronger than its defaults.

09 / BE THE CAPABLE GUARDIAN

Make yourself the target hackers skip

01

Turn on 2FA or a passkey everywhere

Stolen passwords stop working

02

Set a WhatsApp two-step PIN

The code scam fails

03

Never share an OTP with anyone

No one can “borrow” your account

04

Check recovery email and phone

No silent takeovers

05

Log out unknown devices

Intruders get kicked out

Hackers look for the easiest target. **Don’t be it.**

Thank you / Questions?